01 | CCEs | RESOURCE

Using the CLEAR Communication Elements

How the six CCEs help leaders and staff share clear direction

The CCE Administrative Directive applies to written direction from leadership. Any staff member can also use the six questions to understand an assignment, ask about a missing detail, or check a handoff. Using the CCEs does not give anyone new approval authority.

What each element should include

01	**What is changing or being asked** Name who the message is for, what they need to do, and the deadline or start date. If the date to share the information is different from the date to do the work, give both.
02	**Why / Why it is changing** Explain the purpose of the work or the problem it solves. “Management asked for it” is not a reason.
03	**Who owns it and who decides** Name the person doing the work and the person who makes the decision. Say what the reader can decide on their own and what needs someone else’s approval.
04	**What is not changing** List the duties, service expectations, rules, or approval steps that stay the same. Only call something unchanged after you have confirmed it.
05	**What to do if it is unclear, and when you will hear back** Say who answers questions and when people can expect a reply. Escalated questions get an answer, or the name of the person handling them, within two working days. If it will take longer, give a date for the next update.
06	**Where this lives (whenever applicable)** If a document applies, give its name, version, and where to find it. If no document applies, you can leave this element out.

Short messages count too

Emails, chat messages, forwards, and reminders that give direction need the CCEs that apply. A greeting, or a reply that only confirms you received something, does not.

Source: Communicating CLEAR training, final series, slides 11–19 and 37–41.

01 | CCEs | RESOURCE (CONTINUED)

Sample CCE Message

This is a made-up example. Replace the details with your own.

CCE	Example wording
1. Action	Service desk staff: review next week's proposed coverage schedule and email any conflicts to your supervisor by noon Thursday.
2. Reason	We need to find coverage gaps before the schedule is final.
3. Owners	Each staff member checks their own availability. The supervisor approves the unit's coverage plan.
4. Unchanged	Current assignments, service hours, approved leave, and duties stay the same until a change is approved.
5. Questions and reply	Send questions to your supervisor. Escalated questions get an answer, or the name of the person handling them, within two working days. If it will take longer, you will get an update.
6. Source	The current coverage schedule is attached. In a real message, attach the approved document or say where to find it.

Draft your next message

Use this space	Your notes
Action and deadline	
Reason and owners	
What stays the same	
Who to ask, and source	

Check that your message was understood

Ask: "So I know I explained this clearly, what will you do next?" Listen for the action, the deadline, and who to contact for help. If something is missing, fix the message.

When you reword a message, do not change the confirmed action, deadline, or decision-maker.

Source: Communicating CLEAR training, final series, slides 11–19 and 37–41.